01 Listen

Undoubtedly the first step: listen to what they actually want. Knowing what to do and how to do it is 80% of the result. So I pay attention to what the goal is, take notes like it matters, and ask until the brief makes sense from the inside out.

02. Black Canvas

No preconceptions. No references that anchor me to someone else's answer. I approach every brief as if I've heard nothing relevant about the space, which lets me bring perspective from scratch. The blank canvas is not a lack of knowledge. It's a deliberate clearing.

03. Read, Research & Relay

Sharpening the axe is the fastest way to cut down the tree. This is where I spend the most time researching until the ground feels solid, building a knowledge base specific enough to be useful and honest enough to be trusted.

My only chance to gather some ball knowledge

04. Time for Tango

Final checks. Grammar, spelling, logic. And always a variation or two, not to confuse but to give the conversation somewhere useful to go.

This step is about making the decision easy for whoever receives the work.

05. Rinse & Repeat

Apply this across every piece of work: copies, ads, designs, briefs, decks, PRDs or what not.

This is what makes a standard, not a project. The goal is for the process to become invisible and the output to be the only thing anyone notices.